

Build a visualization with the AI Assistant

Activity · Visualizations & Interpretation · ~15 min

BEFORE YOU START

- ☐ You've built at least one chart manually (previous handout)
- ☐ You're signed in and your folder is open
- ☐ You know which indicator you want to chart (ANC1, Penta3, ...)

What you'll do

Get the AI Assistant to create the same kind of chart you just built manually — but by typing a request in plain language. Same end result, different path.

1 Open the AI Assistant

The AI chat panel sits on the right side of the **Visualizations** tab. Type a short request like:

"Show me a time-series chart of ANC1 visits over the last 12 months, using outlier-adjusted data."

The AI returns a chart in the panel with three buttons under it — **fullscreen**, **Save as new viz**, **Add to a deck** — and a short narrative explaining what it built and what it could change next.

Be specific about the adjustment. *"Adjusted data"* on its own is ambiguous — the metric exposes four versions: no adjustment, outliers only, completeness only, or both. Say which one in the prompt, or the AI will pick one for you (usually outliers only).

2 Review what the AI returns

The chart sits at the top of the panel; the narrative below it spells out the indicator, the period, and which adjustment the AI used. **Check it against what you asked for:**

- Right indicator? Right period?
- Line chart for a trend, or something else? Does it suit the question?
- Which adjustment did it use? The narrative names it explicitly (e.g. *outlier-adjusted*).

If anything is off, say so in plain language in the same chat — *"Use raw data instead"*, *"Switch to a bar chart"*, *"Cover the last 6 months only"*.

3 Iterate

The first answer rarely lands the chart you want. Refine in short turns:

- *"Break it down by region."*
- *"Add Penta3 on the same axis."*
- *"Show only the last 6 months."*

Each instruction is a small step. The AI also volunteers next-action suggestions at the end of each reply — feel free to use them or ignore them.

4 Save it

When you like what you see, click **Save as new viz** under the chart and put it in your folder. The neighbouring **Add to a deck** button does both in one move if you already have a deck open.

Try it with three indicators

Run the same flow with three different indicators — pick from different programmes (ANC, immunisation, delivery). You'll get a feel for how the AI interprets short requests.

Manual vs AI — when to use which

- **Manual** when you know exactly what you want and clicking is faster than typing.
- **AI** when you want to explore — *"show me something useful about X"* — or when you don't remember the exact filter names.

The AI is an accelerator, not a replacement. You're still the one who decides whether the chart answers your question.

What's next

The next handout is about **writing the interpretation** — the text that goes next to your chart on a slide. Use the six-step framework from the *Reading a viz* reference.